

Module 6: Finances and Funding

Questions	Answers
What is your COGS (Cost of Goods Sold) at production volume (as necessary)? Interview professionals familiar with the manufactured or final cost of the product/technology, or products similar to yours to record a validated COGS number. Make sure you capture all hidden costs in your selected channel.	USD 605 per unit at a production scale of 5,000 units. This includes electronic components (NVIDIA module, memory, wireless), electrical components (wiring, relays, DIN rails), mechanical housing and thermal assembly, and consumables for installation and safety. Full breakdown available in the Financial Projection sheet.
What are the milestones you must hit in the next 18 months and the estimated funds you will require to reach them? Try using TRLs and MRLs (introduced in the last module) to define your development milestones.	We are working to finish our product development, integrate AI training into a working prototype, validate the system through real-world pilots, and prepare for initial commercialization. We are currently at TRL 3. Our goal is to reach TRL 7, MRL 7 within 18 months. To reach this target, we have estimated a funding need of: \$2 million.
Where will you most likely be able to raise cash funds you need? (e.g. government grants, friends and family, angel investors, seed investors, venture capitalists, competitions, corporate partners, debt financing, etc.)	We anticipate raising funds through a combination of government grants (e.g., Michigan Make It, DOE programs), seed-stage venture capital (climate tech and AI-focused), and select early-stage institutional investors. We also have \$350,000 in non-dilutive product support from NVIDIA and Amazon to date.
What are the top 3 key drivers (aka “metrics that matter”) and key assumptions which have the greatest influence on revenue and costs in your financial model?	● Product Development and Testing in a real environment. ● Paid pilots with Consolidated decision makers ● Training the model on real-world data and achieving high precision and accuracy.